

Features, QoL, and Known Bugs

Player-facing v2.4 feature and compatibility reference

What v2.4 delivers

Area	v2.4 status
Starter choices	Deterministic Johto and Kanto trios derived from the full Trainer ID
National Dex	1,025/1,025 species obtainable in one save
Functional forms	61 documented regional or item-driven forms
Trades	No real trade or connection required
Automatic HMs	All eight field HMs work without being taught; HM, badge, map and story checks remain
Battle D-pad	Pressing Up while RUN is focused selects FIGHT without confirming it
Save compatibility	Persistent layouts preserved from v2.0 through v2.3
Frame rate	60 FPS / uncapped-frame-rate hacks remain disabled for hardware stability
Distribution	Code, documentation and xdelta patch only; full ROM remains local

Randomized starters

Each save receives a stable three-choice trio at Elm and a different stable trio at Oak. Choices never include legendary, mythical, sublegendary, Ultra Beast or Paradox species; every candidate is a first-stage Pokemon with an evolution and complete game resources. Each trio has three different primary types, and all six offered species are different. The six classic Johto and Kanto starters remain obtainable on Route 34.

Automatic field HMs

Cut, Surf, Strength, Rock Smash, Whirlpool, Waterfall and Rock Climb work through their original contextual interactions. Fly is available from HM02 in the Bag through FLY / TEACH / CANCEL. Automatic use requires the matching HM, its original badge and at least one non-Egg Pokemon; the first non-Egg party member is the visual actor. HMs remain teachable for battle use.

Preserved field restrictions

Map, story, follower, Rocket disguise, Safari/Pal Park, Surf-state and destination checks remain in the original engine paths. Flash, Dig, Teleport, Headbutt, Sweet Scent and other non-HM field moves still need to be learned.

Preserved features and quality of life

Rebalanced trainers and Gym Leaders; Infinite Candy and Pocket Heal; Portable PC on L; buyable Nature Mints and Ability Capsules; type changes; free Heart Scales after seven Gyms; Master Balls after eight Gyms; hard level cap; Mega Evolution; smoother level curve; and the Kanto endgame boss rush.

v2.2 encounter policy preserved

Only seed stages are newly added to the wild when their later stages can be evolved in the same save. Common families are concentrated in Johto, aquatic families in water tables, and legendary, mythical, paradox and similarly high-power species in Kanto or post-game areas at 1% in every period.

Special form and ability policy

Regional and permanent functional forms have explicit sources. Cosmetic forms, fusions, mounts and automatic battle transformations are not separate capture targets. Terastal remains disabled; Terapagos uses its base form and Filter.

Known compatibility notes

This project prioritizes HGSS stability over exact replication of mechanics designed for later engines. Ball Fetch, Commander, Dancer, Mimicry and Tera Shift use the stable substitutions listed in Ability Changes. Manual save-fixture and long-session hardware testing remain recommended even after automated and build verification.